

Orphism and Rayonism

Developed around 1912 by Robert Delaunay (1885–1941) and Sonia Delaunay (1885–1979), Orphism or Orphic Cubism, was inspired by Cubism, Fauvism, Seurat, Signac and Chevreul. It was named by the French poet Guillaume Apollinaire (1880–1918) after Orpheus, the poet and singer of ancient Greek mythology. Robert Delaunay was interested in the geometric fragmentation of Cubism, but whereas Cubists subdued colour, he used bright colours and abstracted shapes, and deployed Chevreul's theory of Simultaneous Contrast to make his colours appear bright.

Rayonism was developed in Russia in 1911 by Mikhail Larionov (1881–1964) and Natalia Goncharova (1881–1962) after they attended lectures on Futurism by Marinetti. It synthesized Cubism, Futurism and Orphism, creating abstract images based on the effects of light on landscapes or cityscapes. The artists created the name from their use of dynamic lines of contrasting colour to represent criss-crossing rays of light. They debuted their work at the 1913 'Target' exhibition in Moscow, but had all abandoned it by 1915.



Delaunay, *The Red Tower*, 1911-12